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Sandisk Corp (SNDK.O)

Significant Beat and Raise; Robust Margins and FCF Generation as Data Center Momentum Accelerates

CITI'S TAKE

Dec qtr results significantly beat driven by better product mix, accelerating enterprise SSD deployments, and strengthening market demand dynamics. Datacenter continues to be a strong driver of growth (76%/y) expecting it to be the largest market for NAND in 2026 as enterprise SSD demand accelerates as AI workloads scale. Mngmt continues to maintain disciplined capital allocation and supply planning to sustain long-term demand rather than pursuing aggressive capacity expansion. March qtr guidance meaningfully exceeded Street on demand strength from AI proliferation and strong customer visibility, with demand expected to outpace supply at least beyond CY26. We remain constructive on extremely favorable S/D environment persisting through CY27, supportive of pricing plus durable underlying data center demand. Looking ahead, we believe further qualifications of its BICS8 products on QLC provide margin upside. Our ests increase meaningfully. Maintain Buy and higher \$750 Target Price (on 10-11x PE).

Results – Sandisk reported Dec quarter results of \$3.03B (+31% qq, +61% yy) and EPS of \$6.20. This compares with the guidance range for revenues of \$2.55 – \$2.65B, EPS range of \$3.00 – \$3.40. Gross margins came in at 51.1% vs. guidance range of 41% – 43%, operating margins 37.5%. In terms of end markets, datacenter represented 15% of revenues and was up 64% qq while edge (PCs, smartphones and other devices) was 55% of revenues and was also up 21% qq, while consumer represented 30% of revenues and was up 39% qq.

Outlook – F3Q26 (ending Mar) sales outlook of \$4.40B – \$4.80B vs. Street at \$2.9B, gross margin range of 65.0% – 67.0% vs. Street at 49.3%, EPS of \$12.00 – \$14.00 vs. Street at \$5.11.

See below for management callback takeaways

EPS (US\$)	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	FY	FC Cons
2025A	1.81A	0.99A	-0.30A	0.29A	2.79A	2.99A
2026E	1.21A	6.20A	13.97E	16.25E	38.08E	15.37E
Previous	1.22A	3.98E	5.32E	7.14E	17.78E	na
2027E	19.67E	21.73E	18.30E	18.69E	78.39E	29.35E
Previous	9.23E	10.02E	8.47E	8.57E	36.29E	na
2028E	18.56E	16.77E	14.16E	14.77E	64.26E	26.90E
Previous	8.62E	8.14E	6.37E	6.74E	29.87E	na

Source: Company Reports and dataCentral, Citi Research. FC Cons: First Call Consensus.

Buy

Short-Term View: Upside, expires 05-FEB-26

Price (29 Jan 26 16:00) US\$539.30

Target price US\$750.00↑

from US\$490.00

Expected share price return 39.1%

Expected dividend yield 0.0%

Expected total return 39.1%

Market Cap US\$79,036M

Price Performance

(RIC: SNDK.O, BB: SNDK US)



Asiya Merchant, CFA^{AC}

+1-415-951-1752

asiya.merchant@citi.com

Michael Cadiz

+1-415-951-1671

michael.cadiz@citi.com

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Customers are asking for extraordinarily large supply allocations for 2027 and 2028, and the company is willing to support those volumes only if customers provide credible long-term commitments. Some discussions spanning even longer. Management noted that traditional mechanisms, such as non-cancellable purchase orders, proved ineffective during COVID, and are exploring new structures to ensure customers follow through on what they request.

One LTA agreement signed - no prepayments appeared on the balance sheet this quarter because the relevant agreement closed immediately after quarter-end.

While demand remains robust, management emphasized their commitment to ship only to true, real end-demand to avoid customer attempts to pull forward product, as that could lead to over shipping and lower pricing. They are aiming to build a business model that produces more stable and predictable outcomes, avoiding the traditional "through-cycle" mindset.

The decline in bit shipments is expected to be better than seasonality of down 14–16% vs down msd guide due to data-center demand remaining exceptionally strong rather than inventory building.

The NAND industry continues to evolve catalyzed by artificial intelligence, with data center becoming the largest market for NAND in 2026. Data center revenue grew 64% sequentially, driven by accelerating enterprise SSD demand as AI workloads scale. Demand for NAND continues to significantly exceed supply across all end markets with the company now looking at high 60% (could be higher if unconstrained) exabyte growth for 2026 driven by increased customer needs especially in data center.

New VR led KV cache demand of ~75–100 EB in 2027 and expect to likely double but not currently in demand forecasts.

The company extended its joint venture agreement with Kioxia through December 31, 2034, ensuring manufacturing supply and enabling continued production of advanced NAND technology. SanDisk agreed to pay \$1.165 billion for said manufacturing services paid out between 2026 and 2029.

Management noted pricing volatility within the quarter, as prices moved significantly throughout the quarter, resulting in the profitability of any given deal being largely dependent on when in the quarter it was booked. Due to this, it isn't feasible to pinpoint specific segment profitability as much of the quarter involved catching up to several months of rapid market-wide pricing changes.

Company continues to maintain its mid-to-high teens bit growth target through the BiCS8 transition and does not plan to materially increase capital deployment

The company is not planning to price QLC with a substantial discount versus TLC. Instead, the intention is to optimize the value of both product types across the portfolio. Pricing decisions will be dictated by supply-demand dynamics rather than by assigning a large discount to TLC. QLC is expected to be a meaningful revenue driver in 2H, while 1H growth can be attributed to TLC and data center.

On PC/smartphone OEMs, management noted some de-specing is normal and not concerned about impact to supply demand dynamics given the current demand is outstripping supply meaningfully.

Figure 1. SNDK Actual vs Estimates & Street; Estimate Changes

(in \$ millions, except for %, ASP, and EPS)	Q2-26				Q3-26E				2026E			2027E		
	Dec-25				Mar-26				FY			FY		
	Actual	Prior	Street	Guidance	Citi	Prior	Prior Street	Guidance	Citi	Prior	Street	Citi	Prior	Street
Bit growth q/q	2.0%	2.5%		LSD	(4.8%)	(8.0%)			22.7%	21.6%		17.5%	17.3%	
ASP/GB qq	28.5%	15.0%		DD	60.0%	15.0%			66.5%	25.4%		34.9%	20.5%	
Total Revenue	3,025	2,721	2,669	\$2,550 to \$2,650	4,608	2,878	2,800	4400-4800	15,021	11,219	11,049	23,822	15,855	14,438
Change Q/Q	31.1%	17.9%			52.3%	5.8%								
Change Y/Y	61.2%	45.0%			171.8%	69.8%			104.2%	52.5%		58.6%	41.3%	
GM w/charges	51.1%	46.0%	41.6%	41.0% to 43.0%	66.0%	54.0%	49.3%	65-67%	58.1%	48.3%	41.5%	70.1%	62.1%	48.1%
Opex	413	483	458	\$450 to \$475	461	525		450-470	1,777	1,983	1,755	2,018	2,522	1,567
Operating Income	1,133	769	653		2,580	1,029			6,955	3,435	2,826	14,691	7,331	5,380
Operating Margin	37.5%	28.3%	24.5%		56.0%	35.8%			46.3%	30.6%	25.6%	61.7%	46.2%	37.3%
Pretax Income	1,099	727	605		2,550	987			6,819	3,267	2,618	14,571	7,163	5,189
Provision for Income Taxes	132	109	85	\$80 to \$90	357	163		325-375	926	537	391	2,186	1,502	817
Tax rate	12.0%	15.0%	14.1%		14.0%	16.5%			13.6%	16.4%	14.9%	15.0%	21.0%	15.7%
Net Income	967	618	519		2,193	824			5,893	2,730	2,324	12,386	5,661	4,497
EPS - PF Diluted	\$6.20	\$3.98	\$ 3.50	\$3.00 to \$3.40	\$13.97	\$5.32	\$ 5.11	\$12.00-\$14.00	\$38.08	\$17.78	\$ 15.18	\$78.39	\$36.29	\$ 28.45

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Source: Citi Research, FactSet

Short-Term View on Sandisk Corp (SNDK.O)

Direction: Upside
Duration: Within 90 Days (expires 05 Feb 2026)
Date Added: 07 Nov 2025
Category: Earnings, Macro fundamentals, and Valuation

We open an Upside 90-Day ST View on SNDK shares on strong Dec qtr execution as the company continues to benefit from strong demand reflecting hyperscaler eSSD demand momentum driving better pricing, robust margins, and eSSD-mix opportunity, paired with already-favorable and yet still improving industry fundamentals well-supported by limited production. We remain constructive on NAND fundamentals: industry remaining in tight production supply, with eSSDs benefiting from extremely strong hyperscale demand for generative-AI training/inferencing services, and with vendors working to improve profitability over coming quarters through price increases, while judiciously managing supply to expected demand.

Bull/Bear: Sandisk Corp (SNDK.O)

US\$ **950.00**
▲ 76% Upside

US\$ **750.00**
▲ 39% Upside

US\$ **500.00**
▼ 7.3% Downside



Spread 83pp
Current Price and expected returns (upside/downside) as of 29 Jan 2026



BULL Assumptions

- Bull case assumes higher EB growth and improved EB pricing environment.



BASE Assumptions

- Base case as presented in current financial model.



BEAR Assumptions

- Bear case assumes lower EB growth and degraded EB pricing environment.

Sandisk Corp

Company description

Sandisk is a global data storage supplier of NAND flash solutions, including SSDs, memory cards, USB sticks, portable drives, and automotive. For Client customers, the company offers SSDs for the PC, mobile, gaming, automotive, VR, at-home entertainment, and industrial spaces. The company is primarily focused on increasing its share in Enterprise, targeting the Cloud and Data Center segment. The company also leverages its strong brand name to the Consumer end-market for retail and other end-user products, including memory cards, USB sticks, and portable drives. Sandisk was founded in 1988, was then owned by Western Digital from 2016 until its spinout in Feb 2025, and is headquartered in Milpitas, CA. Sandisk's long-standing flash production JV with Kioxia began in 2000 and is signed through 2034. The partnership provides for a steady supply of NAND flash, with each company a co-owner of the production facilities with an ownership split of 51% (Kioxia)/49% (SNDK).

Investment strategy

We rate Sandisk shares Buy as the company focuses on gaining share in the growing Enterprise SSD segment amidst a highly favorable S/D environment expected to persist through CY27, with limited cleanroom capacity situation supportive of pricing, plus durable underlying datacenter demand, coupled with its Bics8 qualifications serving as a competitive moat, and with ongoing mix to datacenter further benefiting margins longer-term. However, we remain prudently cautious on the potential for elevated price competition between key players during the process, particularly from Chinese players who remain aggressive on gaining share, and where currently underutilized industry capacity can very quickly reverse to oversupply within a small window, making the ideal conditions of price increases short-lived.

Valuation

Sandisk's peer set trades at (FactSet) median 3-4x EV/sales, and 9-10x P/E. Our target price for SNDK is \$750, where we value shares at 10-11x FY27 EPS, vs its closest competitor, Kioxia at 10.1x, as well as the larger peer group at 9-10x P/E. We note most peers have DRAM exposure while SNDK does not. However, Kioxia similarly does not have DRAM exposure and trades at 10.1x P/E. That said, we note Sandisk additionally has an estimated \$15-20B in invested capital (replacement cost) within the JV that is not reflected in the company's financials.

Risks

Downside risks that could impede SNDK share price from reaching our target price include: 1) Sandisk's efforts to increase its share in the Enterprise taking longer than expected; 2) macro environment deteriorating and impacting datacenter spend, PC refresh, or AI-PC uptake; and 3) supply-demand imbalances or pricing competition causing volatile pricing fluctuations and significantly impacting margins.

When considering Citi’s Quantative Risk Rating criteria, we do not rate SNDK shares as High Risk given Sandisk was already previously a publicly traded company and was simply spun out of Western Digital rather than as a new IPO. And though it operates in a cyclical industry, Sandisk continues to be a successful, going concern with a reputable brand, IP assets, and an established JV.

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Appendix A-1

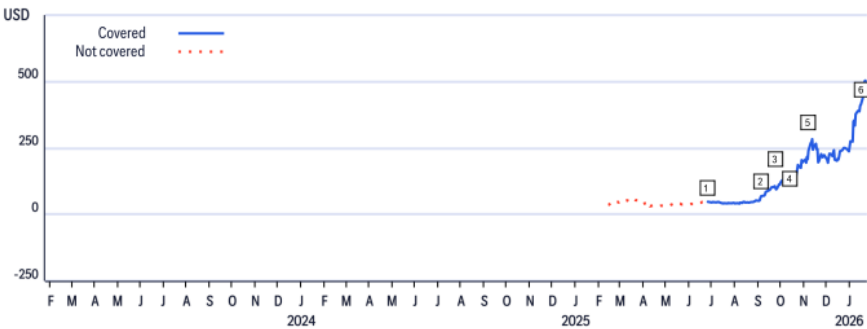
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Sandisk Corp (SNDK)
Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Asiya Merchant, CFA



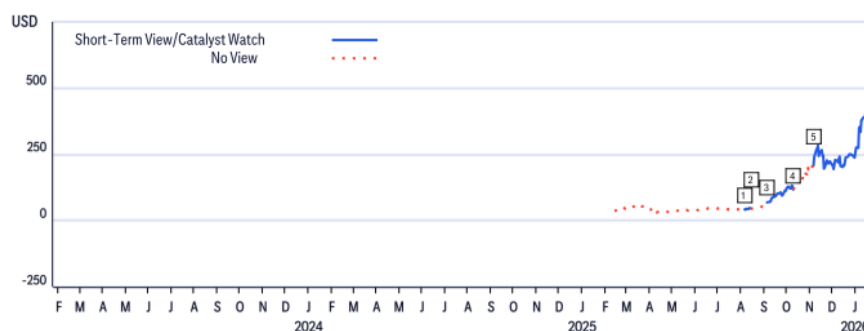
*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Sandisk Corp (SNDK)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Asiya Merchant, CFA



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	06-Aug-25 13:53:54	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	42.10
2	14-Aug-25 22:45:08	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	46.68
3	07-Sep-25 17:24:48	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	68.55
4	12-Oct-25 20:10:56	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	116.91
5	06-Nov-25 19:50:25	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	207.69

CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

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